



Grace at Home

A simple weekly rhythm that turns four pillars into ordinary, around-the-table conversation.

This is the family side of Architecture of Grace. Every practice here aligns to one of the four pillars your child is learning about — **Identity, Self-Compassion, Forgiveness, and Grace** — so the language at home matches the language at school. Nothing takes more than 5–15 minutes. Nothing requires a worksheet, a degree, or a perfect parent. You go first; they follow.

HOW A WEEK WORKS

- **Pick the pillar of the week** (rotate through all four each month).
- **Open with the prompt** at dinner or in the car — one question, no lecture.
- **Do one activity** sometime that week. Ten minutes is plenty.
- **Close with a reflection** question and let the follow-up come naturally.

MAKE IT WORK FOR ANY AGE

- **Little ones (4–7):** keep it concrete — name feelings, draw it, act it out.
- **Middle (8–12):** ask for examples from their day; let them quiz you back.
- **Teens (13+):** trade stories as equals; resist fixing, just listen.
- **Mixed ages:** let older kids model; let younger kids surprise you.

THE FOUR-WEEK MONTH

- **Week 1 — Identity:** who we are, and who we're becoming.
- **Week 2 — Self-Compassion:** how we treat ourselves when we fall.
- **Week 3 — Forgiveness:** how we repair and start again.
- **Week 4 — Grace:** how we meet each other gently.

THREE SMALL RULES

- **You go first.** Kids practice grace they've watched, not grace they've been told about.
- **No grades.** There are no wrong answers here — only honest ones.
- **Keep it short.** A two-minute exchange you repeat beats a long talk you dread.

THE WHOLE SYSTEM ON ONE PAGE

Pages 2–5 give you, for each pillar: **weekly prompts, a monthly challenge, family activities, reflection questions, and follow-up discussions.** Page 6 is a ready-to-use "Grace at Home This Week" card you can copy for any week of the year.

Identity

Who we come to believe we are — shaped by what we notice out loud.

WEEKLY PROMPTS — PICK ONE

- "What's one thing you did today that felt **like you**?"
- "When were you proud of **who you were**, not just what you got?"
- "What's something you're good at that has nothing to do with school?"
- "If your friends described you in three words, what would you want them to say?"
- "Who in our family are you most like — and what part?"

Younger: "What makes you *you*?" · Teens: "Where do you feel most yourself?"

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- "Did anyone make you feel seen today? Did you do that for anyone?"
- "What's a label you've outgrown?"
- "What do you hope is true about you a year from now?"

FOLLOW-UP DISCUSSION

Later in the week: "You said you felt most like yourself when _____. How can we make more room for that?" Naming it once is good; protecting it is better.

FAMILY ACTIVITIES (5–15 MIN)

- **Catch them being.** Each day, name one *true thing you saw them be* — patient, curious, brave — not just what they achieved.
- **The strengths jar.** All week, drop in slips naming a strength you noticed in each other. Read them Sunday.
- **Three-word portraits.** Everyone writes three words for each family member. Compare. Talk about the surprises.

REINFORCES AT SCHOOL

Classrooms explore identity through "I am" statements and strengths language. At home you're doing the same work — praising the **person, not only the grade** — so a child hears one consistent message about who they are.

MONTHLY GRACE CHALLENGE — IDENTITY

"The Out-Loud Week." For seven days, say one specific, character-based thing you notice in each family member *out loud*, every day. No achievements allowed — only who they were being. Notice what changes by day seven.

Self-Compassion

How we learn to speak to ourselves when things go wrong.

WEEKLY PROMPTS — PICK ONE

- "What's something hard you tried today, even though it scared you?"
- "When you messed up today, what did you **say to yourself**?"
- "Would you talk to a friend the way you talk to yourself?"
- "What does your kind inside-voice sound like? What about the harsh one?"
- "What do you need when you're disappointed in yourself?"

Younger: "Can we be gentle with ourselves like we are with a puppy?" ·
Teens: "What's your inner critic's favorite line?"

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- "Was today a 'be gentle' day or a 'push yourself' day? How do you know?"
- "What would you tell a friend in your exact situation?"
- "What's one kind thing you could say to yourself tonight?"

FOLLOW-UP DISCUSSION

Circle back: "Earlier you were really hard on yourself about _____. How are you feeling about it now?" Self-compassion grows when someone notices the storm has passed.

FAMILY ACTIVITIES (5–15 MIN)

- **Flip the critic.** When the harsh voice shows up — theirs or yours — help each other "talk to yourself like a friend," out loud.
- **Mistake of the day.** At dinner, everyone shares one slip-up and one kind thing they told themselves. You go first.
- **The friend test.** Write down a harsh self-thought, then rewrite it as if it were advice to your best friend.

REINFORCES AT SCHOOL

Lessons teach kids to notice self-talk and reframe it ("I made a mistake — that's being human"). When the same reframing happens at home, the kind voice gets louder than the critic in both places.

MONTHLY GRACE CHALLENGE — SELF-COMPASSION

"Talk to Yourself Like a Friend." This month, when anyone in the family catches themselves in harsh self-talk, they say it out loud — and someone helps them rephrase it the way they'd speak to a friend. Keep a tally on the fridge of how many flips you make together.

Forgiveness

Moving past mistakes to make room for growth — theirs and ours.

WEEKLY PROMPTS — PICK ONE

- "Is there anything between us that needs a **redo**?"
- "What's harder for you — saying sorry, or accepting one?"
- "Are you carrying something today that you'd feel lighter to set down?"
- "When someone forgave you, how did it feel?"
- "What does a **real** apology include?"

Younger: "Should we have a do-over?" · Teens: "What makes forgiveness feel earned vs. fake?"

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- "Did anything get repaired today? What helped?"
- "Is there a grudge that's costing you more than it's worth?"
- "What's the difference between forgiving and pretending it didn't happen?"

FOLLOW-UP DISCUSSION

A day after a repair: "How are we doing since our redo? Anything still tender?" Forgiveness isn't a single moment — checking back tells a child repair is real, not performance.

FAMILY ACTIVITIES (5–15 MIN)

- **The four-step redo.** Practice the repair steps together: **own it** · **name the impact** · **make it right** · **reset**. You model one of your own first.
- **Mistake of the week.** At a weekly meal, each person shares a mistake and what they'd redo. The grown-ups go first — it makes repair normal, not scary.
- **Set it down.** Write a grudge on paper, talk about it, then crumple or recycle it together.

REINFORCES AT SCHOOL

The classroom teaches repair as a skill with clear steps, not just "say sorry." Walking the same four steps at home means a child practices real accountability in the place it matters most.

MONTHLY GRACE CHALLENGE — FORGIVENESS

"One Real Repair." Sometime this month, every family member completes one genuine four-step redo with someone — inside or outside the family. Come back and share what was hard about it and what felt better afterward. The goal isn't perfection; it's practice.

WEEKLY PROMPTS — PICK ONE

- "Who could use a little extra patience from you this week?"
- "When did someone give **you** grace today?"
- "What's a story we don't know about why someone acted the way they did?"
- "Where could we choose **connection before correction** this week?"
- "What's something kind you did that no one noticed?"

Younger: "How can we be extra gentle with someone today?" · Teens: "When is grace hardest to give?"

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

- "Did I lead with curiosity or with judgment today?"
- "Who deserves the benefit of the doubt from me right now?"
- "What would change if I assumed the best about them?"

FOLLOW-UP DISCUSSION

End of week: "Where did grace change how a moment went this week — for you or for us?" Naming the wins teaches kids that gentleness is powerful, not weak.

FAMILY ACTIVITIES (5–15 MIN)

- **Connection before correction.** Before the lecture, take one calm breath and ask one kind question. Your calm is the intervention.
- **Grace you received.** Go around and each name one moment today someone was gentle with you.
- **The benefit of the doubt.** Pick a frustrating moment and invent three kind reasons the other person might have acted that way.

REINFORCES AT SCHOOL

Classrooms frame grace as meeting others (and ourselves) with understanding first. At home, "connection before correction" gives a child the same gentle on-ramp back from a hard moment.

MONTHLY GRACE CHALLENGE — GRACE

"Connection Before Correction." For one month, before any correction, the adults pause for a single breath and one kind question first. Notice how often the lecture turns out to be unnecessary. Invite the kids to call it out — gently — when you forget.

Grace at Home **This Week**

A ready-to-use card. Copy it for any week — just swap the pillar and the five fields.

This Week's Pillar

GRACE

PARENT PROMPT

Before any correction this week, take one breath and ask one kind question first. Then tell your child at dinner: *"I tried leading with a question today instead of a lecture — here's what happened."*

STUDENT PROMPT

"When did someone give *you* grace today — went easy on you, gave you the benefit of the doubt? How did it feel?"

FAMILY ACTIVITY

Benefit of the doubt. Pick one frustrating moment from the week. Together, invent three kind reasons the other person might have acted that way. (10 min)

REFLECTION QUESTION

"Did I lead with curiosity or with judgment today? Who deserves the benefit of the doubt from me right now?"

EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Pick one person outside the family — a sibling's friend, a neighbor, a teacher — and offer them a small, unprompted bit of grace this week (patience, a kind note, a second chance). At the next dinner, share what you did and what you noticed. *Grace grows when it leaves the house.*

HOW TO RUN "THIS WEEK"

- Post the card somewhere everyone sees it — fridge, table, family chat.
- Use the **Parent** and **Student** prompts as conversation openers, not assignments.
- Fit the **Activity** into a meal or car ride once during the week.
- Close the week with the **Reflection** question; let the **Extension** stretch grace beyond the four walls.

MAKE YOUR OWN EACH WEEK

Rotate the pillar (Identity → Self-Compassion → Forgiveness → Grace) and pull the five fields straight from that pillar's page in this packet. Four cards gives you a full month; twelve months of cards gives you a **Family Grace Journey**.